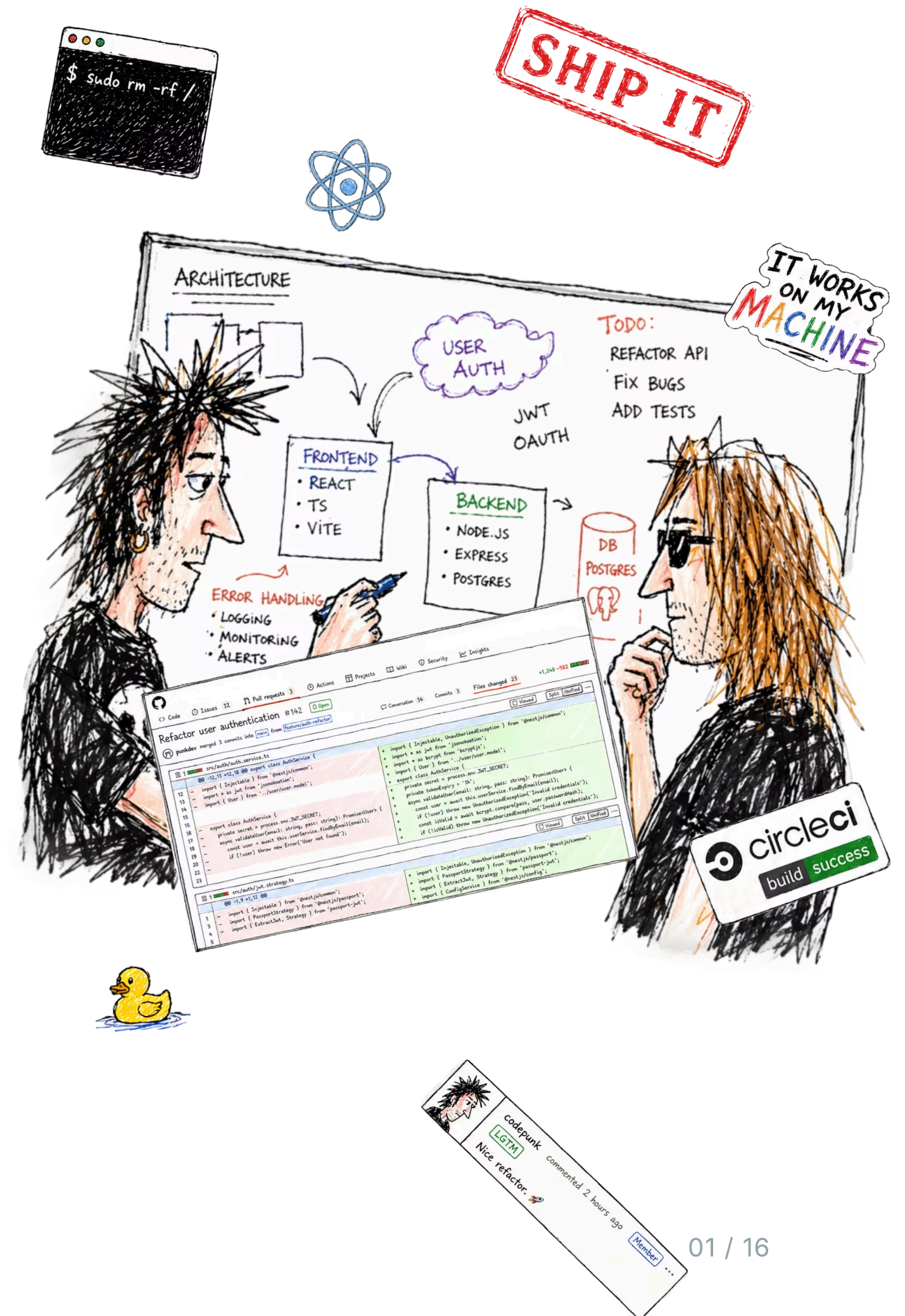
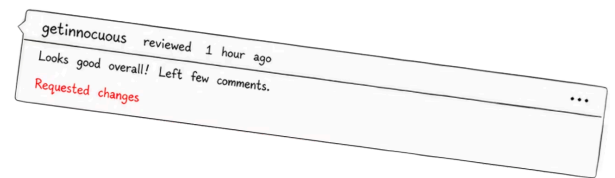


Pull Requests Are Dead. Long Live Code Review

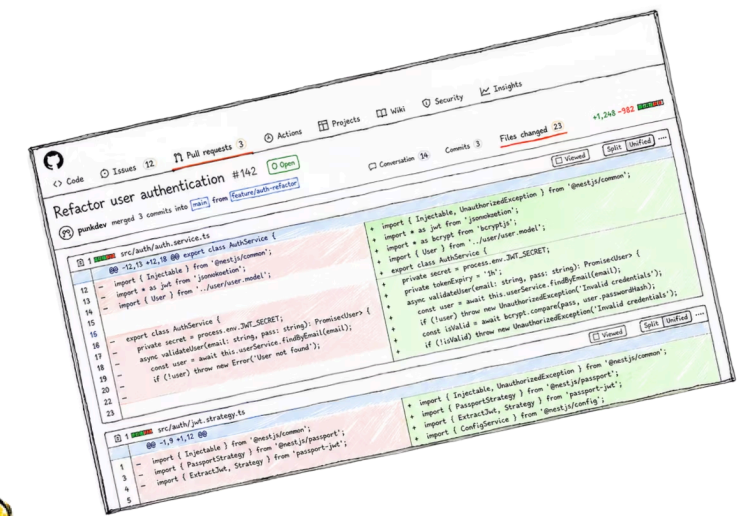
Dylan Ratcliffe





Lesson 1

AI is not your peer



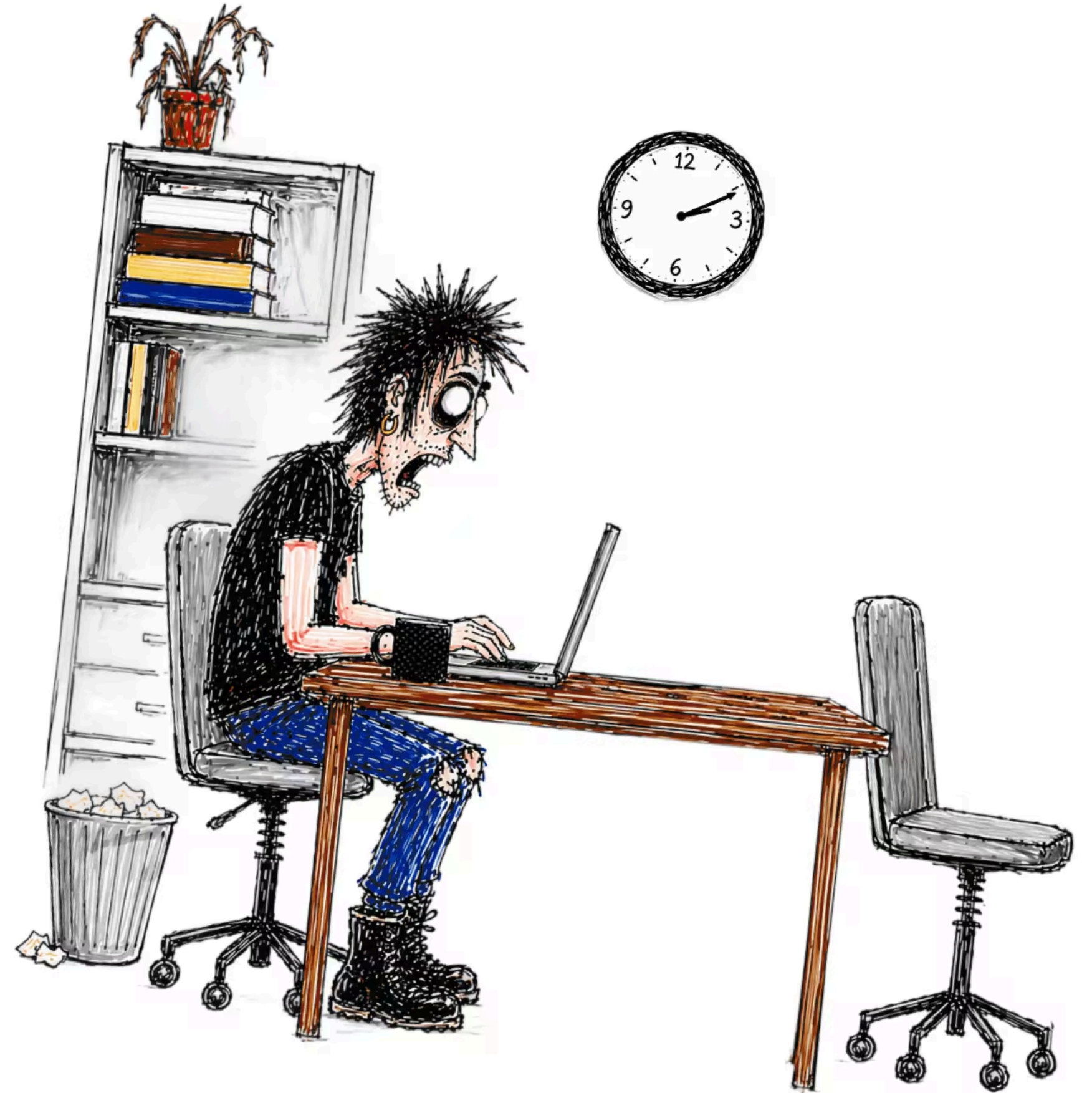
What we used code review for

Catching bugs.
SOC2 compliance.
Training juniors.
Tribal knowledge.



Then we tried it on AI-written code

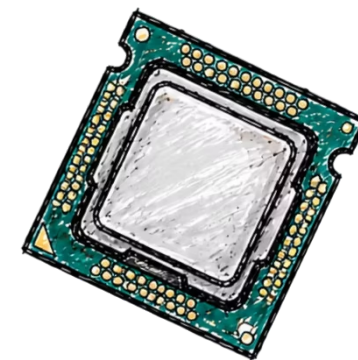
You're absolutely right!



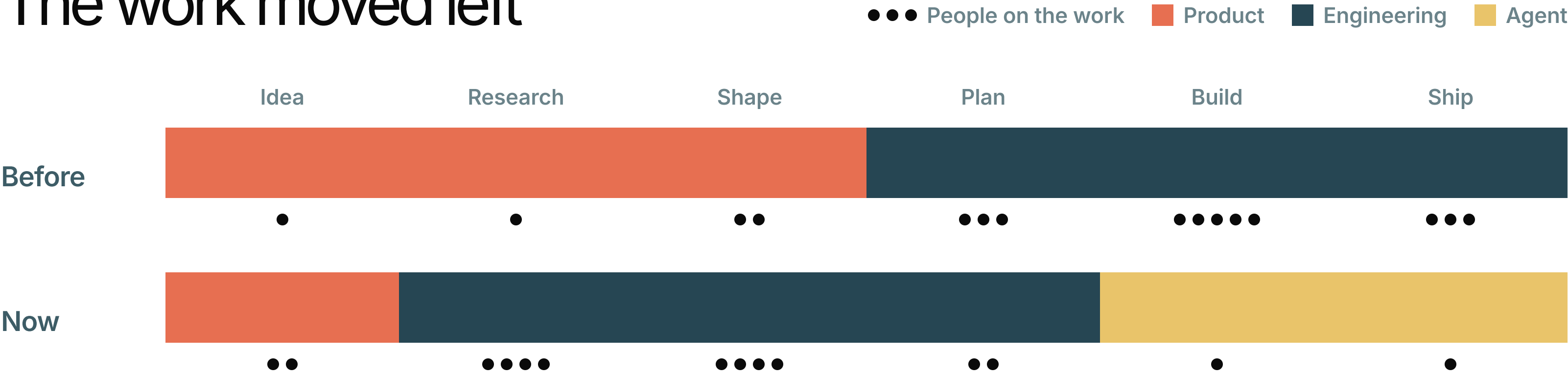


Lesson 2

If your job is converting detailed specs → quality code, you're out of a job



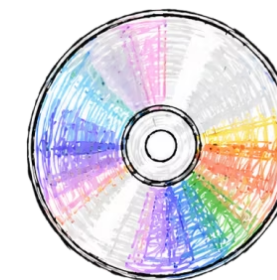
The work moved left



Once the plan existed, handing it to an agent was faster than handing it to a person.

Lesson 3

Not all loops are created equal



do ... while

do_while.sh

```
1 do
2   agent.pickup(ticket)
3   agent.decide_approach()
4   agent.make_tradeoffs()
5   agent.write_code()
6   agent.write_tests()
7 while human.audit()
```

The interesting decisions already happened. You audit them.

until

until.sh

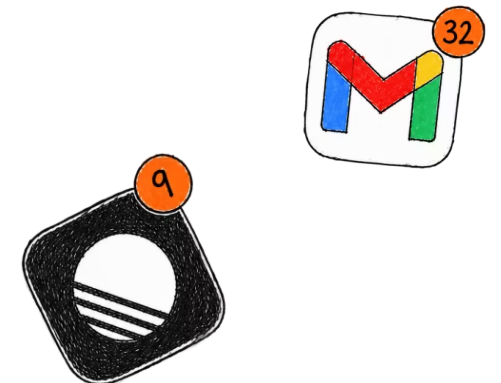
```
1 agent.research_codebase()
2 human.decide_approach()
3 human.make_tradeoffs()
4 plan = human.write_with(agent)
5
6 until agent.matches(plan)
7 do
8   agent.implement(plan)
9 done
```

Define the condition first. An agent can check if the code matches.



Lesson 4

Human attention is precious



First two weeks. Same team.

3.2x

issues completed

3.4x

commits

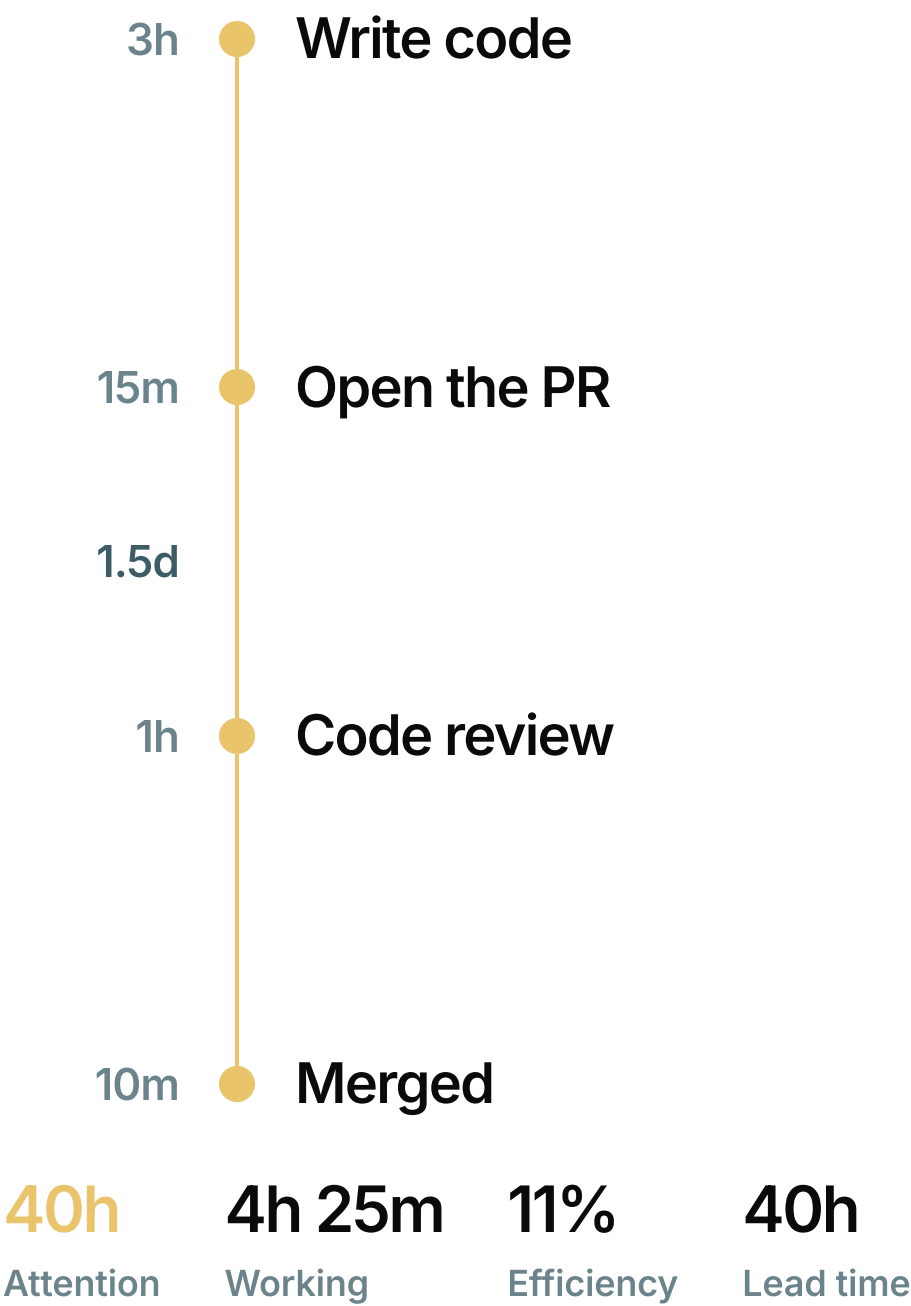
3.2d → 1.3d

lead time -59%

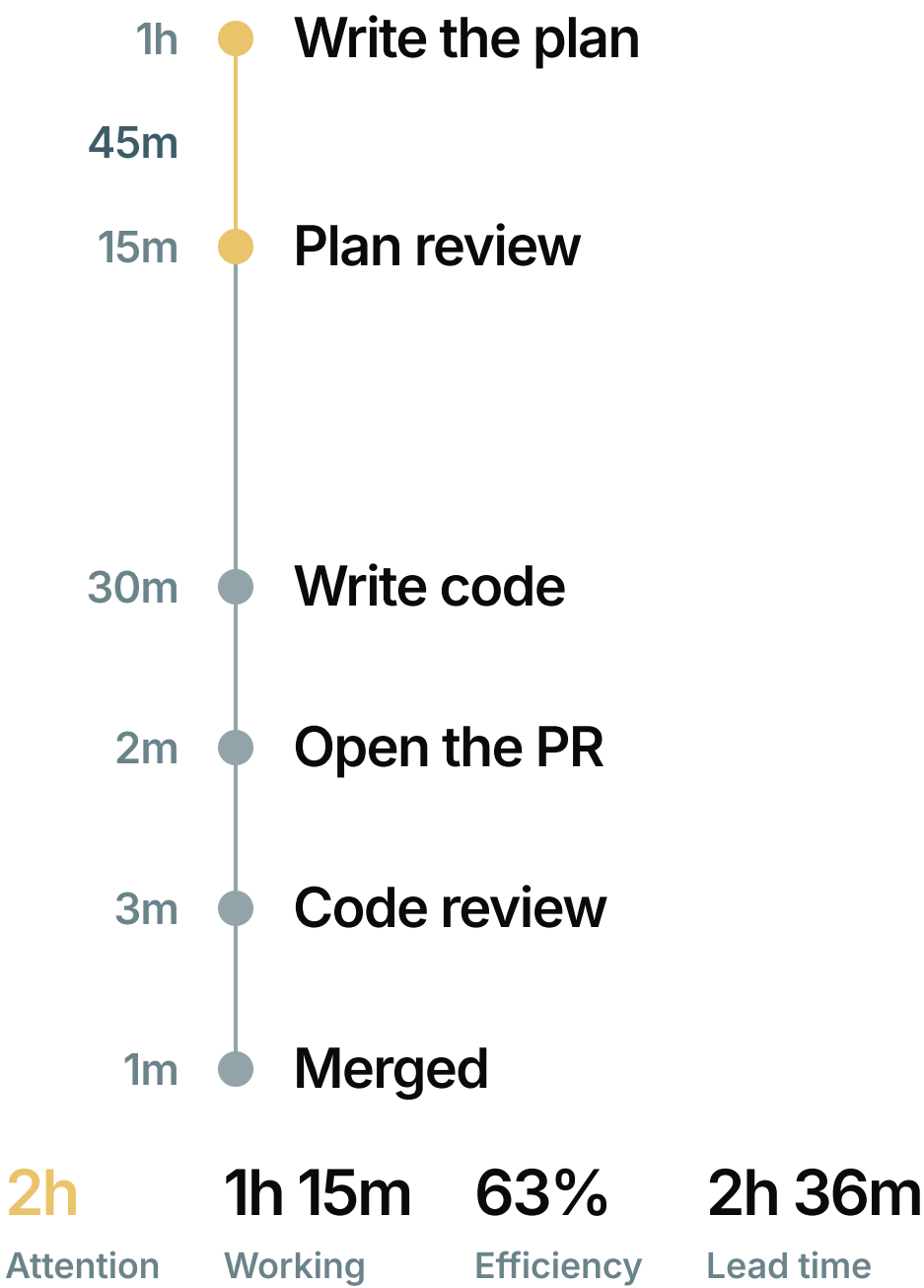
A 2h ticket

Human attention required Automated

Pull request



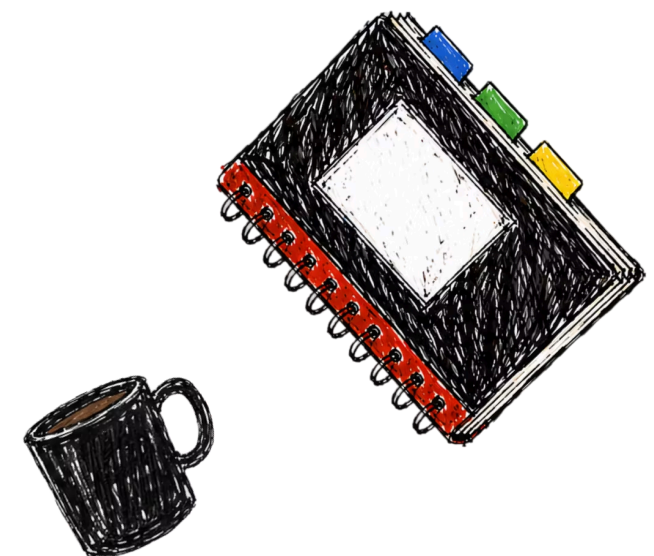
Until loop





Lesson 5

Reject the recipe, not the meal



What a rejection adds

+40m

to a rejected plan

+16h

to a rejected PR

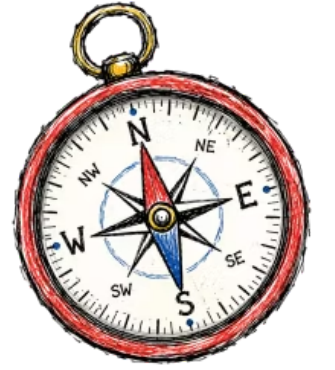
2.8x

more likely to give feedback

8%

of plans abandoned

zero code written



Lesson 6

When anyone can make anything, the big differentiator is ~~what you choose to make~~ how you choose to make it

Paul Graham



What: a laptop.



ThinkPad X1 Carbon

14" display · 120Hz
32GB memory
1TB SSD
12.3" wide



MacBook Pro 14"

14" display · 120Hz
32GB memory
1TB SSD
12.3" wide



The job of engineering is going to change

You must

- Pick the loop that puts you at the top, not the agent

This will happen

- You will stop caring about some of the how
- New how questions will take their place
- Still interesting. Still engineering. Still a team.
- It can be more fun than ever

until.dev

